

Bioconductor Community Advisory Board (CAB) Agenda

Jan 08, 2026

9 pm UTC Nov '25 – Feb '26

Members: Aedin, Eliana, Enis, Fabricio, Izabela, Johannes, Kevin, Kozo, Laurent, Lluís, Lori, Maria, Martha, Mengbo, Oluwatobilola (Tobi), Stevie, Tuomas, Umar, Zahraa, Zuguang

Attending: Laurent, Eliana, Tuomas, Kevin, Stevie, Kozo, Izabela, Nicholas, Enis, Maria, Tobi. Lori (Late), Lluís (Late)

Regrets: Johannes

Guests: Leo

:00 - :5 Welcome + Review minutes from previous meeting for posting

[Dec 2025](#)

:5–10 Managing Ongoing Tasks

<https://github.com/orgs/Bioconductor/projects/15>

We understand that this is volunteer but to keep track of ideas and TODOs and try to push things forward that we feel are important

:10-30: CAB Led Discussion: Leo

Link to slides (TBAdded)

Title: Opportunities and pitfalls in Bioc community engagement: experiences from microbiome community building efforts

- [History of science: The crucible of change | Nature](#) - "What marks out modern science is not the conduct of experiments (alchemists also conducted experiments), but the formation of a critical community capable of assessing discoveries and replicating results."
- From phyloSeq to (Tree)SE
- Pitfalls: community building takes time & life situation changes; moving targets (fast moving life sciences); friction to change (eg new data structures, technologies); substantial infrastructure work (limited resources, skills, interest); substantial PR work (limited resources, skills, interest); giving credit & expectations can work; relations and random chance play a role.
- Kevin: Community and maintenance - [RSMF Round 2: Announcing key updates and timeline | SSI](#)
 - Kevin is exploring the possibility to submit an EoI around Bioconductor

- The example of this microbiome community would be a great example of positive products from the Bioconductor prto highlight in such a proposal

:30-:50 Discussion Point Follow Up

Nicholas's discussion points

- Adding to existing packages -> Focus on hackathons, building on strengths of tidyomics & Orchestrating Spatial experiences. Hacktoberfest is tough for release timing
- Is "BioconductorFest" an idea we should follow up?
 - Kevin: This could include informal hackathon sessions, encouraging less experienced R users to practice their programming on fun taks, e.g.
 - <https://github.com/kevinrue/BiocPkgToolsPlus> uses BiocPkgTools to analyse the Bioconductor package ecosystem. Note that an added benefit of doing that at a Bioconductor event is that it allows hack(athon)ers to ask technical questions to Core team members present at the event.
- <https://github.com/kevinrue/biocwallpaper> (work in progress) repackages code in <https://github.com/kevinrue/biochexwall/> to produce a package that will facilitate the production of 'hexwalls' from vignettes hosted on <https://github.com/Bioconductor/BiocStickers>

Laurent & Maria discussion points

- Coffee times + Bioconductor seminar series?

Collection of points to bring to next conference committee meetings

- Awards
- New participant badge
- Instead of meet CAB/TAB - "happy hour" mingle
- "Buddy system"

:50-:55 Bioc Asia Report [Stevie]

:55-:00 Any Other Business

February agenda:

We were thinking of having some presentations on currently awarded fellowships/grants/etc. Does anyone want a spot to briefly describe goals/aims?

Kevin - Fellowship

Lori - R50

Others?

TAB looking at a joint meeting in March. Be on lookout for more information